Benefits, Limitation and troubleshooting of Managed Applications

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🟣 Benefits of Managed Applications

- **Compliance.** Solutions align with regulatory and security requirements for sensitive data, because nothing leaves the customer's environment.
- **Publisher control.** Simplified updates, patches and maintenance inside customer subscriptions.
- **Unique Azure capability.** No other major cloud provider offers an equivalent to Managed Applications.
- **Scalable revenue.** A strong fit for enterprise deals that require deployment flexibility, with Marketplace billing keeping procurement simple.

🟣 Limitations and things to watch

- **Flat monthly fee only.** No per-user pricing and no annual term. *Workaround:* emulate a term with custom meters, accepting that renewal enforcement moves into your contract and application.
- **Access settings are permanent.** Publisher management and customer access cannot be changed once the offer is live. *Workaround:* decide before publishing, and use a security group as the principal so you can change who has access later.
- **Publishing is slow.** Certification of template files is manual, so both first publication and every update take roughly a day. *Workaround:* batch offer changes and plan releases around it.
- **Updates are per customer.** No central push. *Workaround:* automate with CI/CD and cross-tenant management if you have the engineering capacity.
- **No proration on cancellation.** *Workaround:* none — set the expectation with the customer, and flag the 72-hour refund window.
- **Deployment starts at private offer acceptance.** *Workaround:* do not cancel a deployment after acceptance, or the Purchase button never appears and the private offer must be re-created.

🟣 Troubleshooting

Symptom	Likely cause	Fix
Package validation fails on upload	Wrong file names or casing, files not at the zip root, or a template that fails ARM TTK	Confirm **mainTemplate.json** and **createUiDefinition.json** are exactly named and at the root; run ARM TTK locally to see the specific failures.
Purchase button never becomes clickable on a private offer	Still inside the 15–60 minute preparation window, or the deployment was cancelled after acceptance	Wait and refresh; if the deployment was cancelled, re-initiate the private offer
Customer gets **DenyAssignmentAuthorizationFailed**	Working as designed – the deny assignment blocks customer writes to the managed resource group	Explain the model; if the customer genuinely needs write access, that had to be configured before the offer went live
Publisher cannot see the deployment	Looking in the wrong blade	Use **Managed applications center**, not the customer-facing **Managed applications** blade
Customer cannot find their deployment	They do not remember the resource group	Send them to **Managed applications** in the Azure portal, which lists all of them
Create button missing on the deployment blade	Terms checkbox not ticked	Ask the customer to tick "I agree to the terms and conditions above"

🟣 FAQs

How are Managed Applications updated? For existing customers you update the resources directly in the managed resource group. For new customers you update the zip package in the plan. Both must be kept in sync. Automated update pipelines are possible, but most publishers do this manually.

Who pays for infrastructure costs? The customer, directly through their own Azure subscription – unless you configure the plan for ISV-billed infrastructure, in which case you do.

Do customers have access to the application resources? It depends on your configuration. The default is read-only visibility enforced by deny assignments, but you can grant full access or restrict it further. This cannot be changed after the offer is live.

Is Azure usage required for publishers? No. The solution runs in customer environments, so you do not need Azure consumption of your own.

How does a customer cancel? By deleting the managed application resource in their subscription. Azure removes the managed resource group and stops future billing. The current month's fixed fee is charged in full – there is no proration. A refund is only available if the application is deleted within 72 hours of purchase.

Can I charge annually or per user? Not with the standard price – only a flat monthly fee is supported. Term-based pricing can be emulated with custom meters, with the trade-offs described above.

How long does publishing take? Around 24 hours for the initial publication, and about the same for republishing, because certification of the template files is manual.

Why is the Purchase button not appearing on my private offer? After acceptance it takes 15 to 60 minutes to become available. It will also never appear if the deployment was cancelled after acceptance – in that case the private offer has to be re-initiated.

What scenarios require Managed Applications? Regulated industries, cybersecurity, and any solution that has to analyse or run inside the customer's own environment.

💬 ***For more, contact us at : support@wetransact.io***

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